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Hydrangea plant named ‘3792resgea’

Abstract

A new and distinct cultivar of *Hydrangea* plant, referred to by its cultivar name, ‘3792resgea’, is disclosed. The new variety forms dark pink-colored inflorescences. Very strong stems which prevent flopping are formed. A moderately vigorous, well-branched, dense, and compact growth habit is displayed. The new variety is well suited for providing ornamentation in the landscape.

Latin Name:	Hydrangea arborescens 3792resgea
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Background/Summary

(1) Latin name of genus and species of plant claimed: *Hydrangea arborescens*.

(2) Variety denomination: '3792resgea'.

STATEMENT REGARDING PRIOR DISCLOSURES BY THE INVENTOR

(3) The first offer for sale of the new variety was July 2024, in the United States of America, at the New Varieties Showcase at the Cultivate Trade Show in Columbus, Ohio, followed by the publication of the 2025 Star Roses and Plants Woody Ornamentals & Edibles Catalog released Oct. 7, 2024. The first offer for sale of the new variety was by an inventor or another who obtained the new variety directly or indirectly from an inventor. No plants of the new variety have been sold in this country or anywhere in the world, nor has any disclosure of the new plant been made, more than one year prior the effective filing date of this application, and such sale or disclosure within one year was either derived directly or indirectly from the inventor.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

(4) The new cultivar originated in Cochranville, Pennsylvania in June 2016 in a controlled breeding program. The breeding program's objective was the development of *Hydrangea* cultivars that have improved compact growth habits with sturdy non-flopping flowers in a range of colors with good leaf spot resistance. The new cultivar is the result of open pollination. The female parent (i.e., the seed parent) of the new cultivar is an unnamed seedling that is the product of the cross of *Hydrangea arborescens* 'NCHA2' (U.S. Plant Pat. No. 28,316) and *Hydrangea arborescens* 'PIIHA-I' (U.S. Plant Pat. No. 21,227). The male parent (i.e., the pollen parent) is unknown.

(5) The parentage of the new variety can be summarized as follows:

('NCHA2' x 'PIIHA-I') x unknown

(6) The new cultivar was discovered and selected as a single flowering plant within the progeny of the above stated experiment during June 2021 in a controlled environment in Cochranville, Pennsylvania.

(7) The new variety has been found to undergo asexual propagation in Cochranville, Pennsylvania by terminal stem cuttings. Asexual propagation by terminal stem cuttings in Cochranville, Pennsylvania has shown that the characteristics of the new variety are stable and are strictly transmissible by asexual propagation from one generation to another. Accordingly, the new variety undergoes asexual propagation in a true-to-type manner.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(8) It was found that the new variety of *Hydrangea* plant of the present invention possesses the following combination of characteristics: (a) forms dark pink-colored inflorescences, and (b) displays a well-branched, dense, and compact growth habit.

(9) The new variety well meets the needs of the horticultural industry. It can be grown to advantage as ornamentation in parks, gardens, public areas, and in residential settings. Accordingly, the plant is particularly well suited for growing in the landscape.

(10) The new variety of the present invention can readily be distinguished from its ancestors. More specifically, plants of the new cultivar differ from the female parent variety (i.e., product of 'NCHA2' x 'PIIHA-I') in that the new cultivar has stronger stems preventing flopping, whereas the female parent variety does flop.

(11) Moreover, the new variety can be readily distinguished from other similar non-parental varieties. Of the many commercially available *Hydrangea* cultivars, the most similar in comparison to the new cultivar is the 'NCHA2' variety (U.S. Plant Pat. No. 28,316). However, in comparison, plants of the new cultivar differ from plants of the 'NCHA2' variety at least because the new cultivar has inflorescences that are darker pink than the inflorescences of the 'NCHA2' variety, and has sturdier stems that are more resistant to flopping than plants of the 'NCHA2' variety.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE PHOTOGRAPHS

(1) The accompanying photographs show, as nearly true as it is reasonably possible to make the same in color illustrations of this type, typical flower and foliage characteristics of a plant of the new cultivar. Colors in the photographs differ slightly from the color values cited in the detailed description, which accurately describes the colors of the '3792resgea' variety. The plant of the new cultivar was approximately two years old and was observed in July 2024, while growing in a two-gallon container in Cochranville, Pennsylvania, U.S.A.

(2) FIG. 1—illustrates a side view of the overall growth and flowering habit.

(3) FIG. 2—illustrates a closeup view of the inflorescence.

DETAILED BOTANICAL DESCRIPTION

(4) The chart used in the identification of the colors is that of The Royal Horticultural Society (The R.H.S. Colour Chart, 2015 edition), London, England, except where general color terms of ordinary significance are used. The terminology which precedes reference to the chart has been added to indicate the corresponding color in more common terms and The R.H.S. Colour Chart designation used herein represents the closest color observed on the majority of the specified botanical feature. The color values were determined in June 2024, under natural light conditions in Cochranville, Pennsylvania. The description is based on the observation of plants produced from cuttings from stock plants and grown in three-gallon containers for approximately two years in an outdoor nursery in Cochranville, Pennsylvania. Measurements and numerical values represent averages of typical plants. Botanical classification: *Hydrangea arborescens* cultivar '3792resgea'. Propagation: *Type cutting*.—Terminal stem cuttings. *Time to initiate roots during the summer*.—Approximately 14 days. *Time to initiate roots during the winter*.—Approximately 24 days. *Root description*.—White, fine, fibrous. *Rooting habit*.—Moderate branching and density. Plant description: *Commercial crop time*.—Approximately 24 months from a rooted cutting to finish in a 3-gallon pot. *Growth habit and general appearance*.—Deciduous shrub, moderately vigorous, and upright growth habit. *Hardiness*.—USDA Zones 3-8. *Size*.—Height from soil level to top of plant plane: approximately 54.0 cm on average. Width: approximately 50.0 cm on average. *Branching habit*.—Freely branching; pinching enhances branching. Quantity of lateral branches per plant: approximately 12. *Branches*.—Shape: rounded. — strength: strong. — length to base of inflorescence: approximately 55.0 cm on average. — diameter: approximately 5.0 mm on average. — length of central internode: approximately 7.0 cm on average. — texture of young stem: glabrous. — texture of mature stem: woody. — color of young stem: Yellow-Green Group 146C. — color of mature stem: Grey-Brown Group N199D. — quantity of lenticels per internode: approximately 30 on average. — size of stem's lenticel: typically 0.5 mm to 1.0 mm in diameter. — shape of stem's lenticel: round to elliptic. — color of stem's lenticel: Grey-Brown Group 199C. Mature surface texture of exfoliating bark: papyraceous. — color of exfoliated bark: Greyed-Orange Group 166B. Foliage: *General description*.—Quantity of leaves per lateral branch: approximately 22 on average. — fragrance: none detected. — form: simple. — arrangement: opposite. *Leaves*.—Aspect: flat. — shape: elliptic. — margin: serrated. — apex: acuminate. — base: rounded. — venation pattern: pinnate. — length of mature leaf: approximately 11.0 cm on average. — width of mature leaf: approximately 5.0 cm on average. — texture of upper surface: coriaceous, glabrous. — texture of lower surface: coriaceous, glabrous. — color of upper surface of young foliage: Green Group 143B with venation of Yellow-Green Group 146D. — color of lower surface of young foliage: Yellow-Green Group 146C with venation of Yellow-Green Group 147D. — color of upper surface of mature foliage: Green Group 137A with venation of Yellow-Green Group N148C. — color of lower surface of mature foliage: Yellow-Green Group 147B with venation of Yellow-Green Group 146D. — color of upper surface in the fall: Yellow-Green Group 146C. — color of lower surface in the fall: Yellow-Green Group 146D. — dormant terminal leaf bud size: length is approximately 9.0 mm on average and width is approximately 3.5 mm on

average. — dormant terminal leaf bud color: Greyed-Orange Group 165A. *Petiole*.—Length: approximately 4.0 cm on average. — diameter: approximately 2.5 mm on average. — texture of upper and lower surfaces: glabrous. — color: Grey-Brown Group 199B. Flowering description: *Flower type and habit*.—Single fertile and sterile flowers arranged on large terminal panicles. *Fragrance*.—None detected. *Natural flowering season*.—Seasonal, continuously flowering from summer through fall in Cochranville, Pennsylvania. *Lastingness of individual inflorescence on the plant*.—Persistent. Inflorescence: *General description*.—Height: approximately 7.0 cm on average. — width: approximately 14.0 cm on average. — shape: terminal mop-head. — quantity per plant: one per lateral or sublateral stem. — aspect: face upward. — quantity of fertile florets per inflorescence: approximately 200 on average. — quantity of sterile florets per inflorescence: approximately 600 on average. *Peduncle*.—Strength: strong. — shape: rounded. — length: approximately 2.5 cm on average. — diameter: approximately 1.7 mm on average. — texture: moderately pubescent. — color: Greyed-Purple Group 183D. Floret description: *General description*.—Type: single, sterile and fertile flowers. *Fertile flowers*.—Flower diameter: approximately 6.0 mm on average. — flower depth (height): approximately 5.0 mm on average. — flower bud length, just before opening: approximately 4.0 mm on average. — flower bud diameter, just before opening: approximately 1.5 mm on average. — flower bud shape, just before opening: globular. — flower bud color, just before opening: Red-Purple Group 67D. — petal arrangement: rotate. — petal length: approximately 2.0 mm on average. — petal width: approximately 1.0 mm on average. — petal shape: cymbiform. — petal apex: acute. — petal base: truncate. — petal margin: entire. — petal texture of upper and lower surfaces: glabrous. — petal color: when first open, upper surface: Red-Purple Group 63B. when first open, lower surface: Red-Purple Group 63D. when fully opened, upper and lower surfaces: Red-Purple Group 65A. — pedicel: aspect: erect. strength: strong. length: approximately 2.0 mm on average. diameter: typically less than 1.0 mm. texture: glabrous. color: Yellow-Green Group 145C. — conspicuousness of fertile flowers within the inflorescence: weak. *Sterile flowers*.—Flower diameter: approximately 1.7 cm on average. — flower depth (height): approximately 5.0 mm on average. — flower bud length, just before opening: approximately 2.0 mm on average. — flower bud diameter, just before opening: approximately 1.5 mm on average. — flower bud shape, just before opening: globular. — flower bud color, just before opening: Green Group 138B. — sepals: quantity per flower: typically 3 to 5. attitude: open and flat. intensity of overlapping sepals: absent to minimal. length: approximately 18.0 mm on average. width: approximately 11.0 mm on average. shape: broadly elliptic. apex: broadly acute. base: cuneate. margin: entire. texture, upper surface: glabrous. texture, lower surface: glabrous. color: when first open, upper surface: Greyed-Purple Group 185D. when first open, lower surface: Red-Purple Group 59D. when fully opened, upper and lower surfaces: Red-Purple Group 64D. when aging, upper and lower surfaces: Red Group 56C. — pedicel: aspect: erect. strength: strong. length: approximately 1.0 cm on average. diameter: approximately 1.0 mm on average. texture: sparsely pubescent. color: Yellow-Green Group 144D. *Reproductive organs, fertile flowers*.—Stamens: quantity per flower: approximately 10 on average. stamen length: approximately 4.0 mm on average. filament quantity: 8. filament color: Orange-White Group 159D. anther shape: round. anther length: approximately 0.5 mm on average. anther color: White Group 155A. pollen amount: very sparse. pollen color: White Group 155C. pistil quantity per flower: two, fused. pistil length: approximately 1.0 mm on average. stigma shape: oval. stigma color: White Group NN155A. style length: typically less than 1.0 mm. style color: White Group 155A. ovary color: White Group 155A. Development: *Seed and fruit production*.—Neither seed nor fruit production has been observed. *Disease and pest resistance*.—Resistance to pathogens and pests common to *Hydrangea* has not been observed.

(5) The new '3792resgea' cultivar has not been observed under all possible environmental conditions to date. Accordingly, it is possible that the phenotype may vary somewhat with

variations in the environment, such as temperature, light intensity, and day length, without, however, any variance in genotype.

Claims

1. A new and distinct variety of *Hydrangea* plant named '3792resgea' characterized by the following combination of characteristics: (a) forms dark pink-colored inflorescences, and (b) displays a well-branched, dense, and compact growth habit; substantially as herein shown and described.
